

Shree says, "And I also got mutton-flavoured noodles with my dosa."

Another friend teases, "What else you do other than just eating?"

Shree gets angry. She decides to unfriend them. Later feels **FOMO**.

But before she can tell them she's sorry, she gets a new friend request.

It is from a girl called Chaitra. She is very pretty, like a film star.

Shree clicks ACCEPT. One click, and they become friends.

Chaitra types, "Do you have many friends?" "No! And I lost a few friends today." She adds a sad-face emoticon.

"So what? It really doesn't matter how many friends you have—it is the nature of our friendship that matters. And you have me now!"

Shree likes the sound of that.

"Where do you go to school?" types Shree.

"Near your school," types Chaitra.

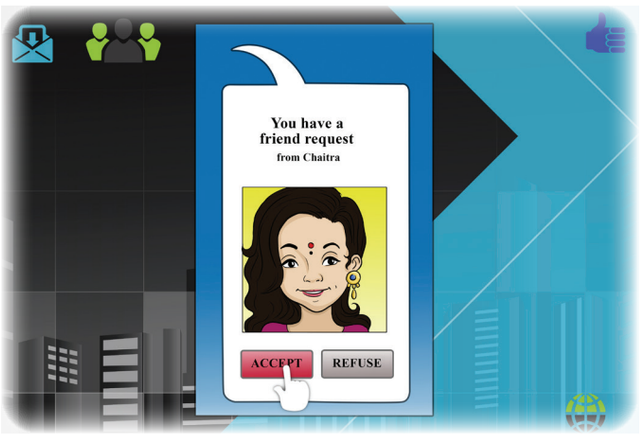
"How do you know which school I go to?" **wonders** Shree.

"Because it is near my school."

"That's nice. Then we can meet," types Shree.

Chaitra signs off. "Yes! And we'll be best friends forever. Bye!"

The next morning, Shree looks for school near hers. But she cannot see one. It is a little strange that she hasn't heard of any other school nearby.



But Chaitra is nicer than all her other friends. She is Shree's special friend and nobody else's friend.

Today she doesn't touch the hot noodles though they are her favourite flavour– chilli chicken.

Akka wonders what is wrong. "Are you unwell?"

"Too much school work," lies Shree.

"Then go and finish your homework, while I take a **nap**," says her aunt.

8th_english_7 to 8 .indd 205 16-12-2022 14:28:01